Groundwork — Weekly Build Report

Monday 26 – Saturday 31 October 2026

Prepared for Ruth Ijoma

A record of everything built on the Groundwork platform this week: the code, the database work, the screen designs, the tests, and the problems found and fixed along the way. It is written for someone not working in the code, so each item says what it means for a contractor or a client rather than how it was built.

210	16,393	2,761	12	22	15
files changed	lines added	lines removed	database migrations	screen designs	new test files

93 changes were committed across five working days, Tuesday to Saturday. Wednesday alone carried 57 of them. Alongside the code, the week produced twelve database migrations, a full set of screen designs for the contractor surface at both desktop and phone sizes, and fifteen new test files.

Read this before anything else

None of this week's work is live on tryjalla.com. Everything described here runs on the development machine only.

This is why Philip repeatedly saw old screens during Friday's session. He spent time clearing his cache and switching to an incognito window; neither could have helped, because the deployed site was simply an older build.

Three things must happen before anyone outside the team sees any of it: the work is deployed, five database migrations are applied, and one email key is set in Vercel. All three are listed under **Blocked**.

Day by day

Monday 26 October

No changes recorded

Nothing was committed on Monday. The week's work begins Tuesday.

Tuesday 27 October

10 commits

Onboarding, the partner application, and the legal documents behind them.

- **Phone numbers validate properly everywhere.** The previous check accepted only one strict international format and rejected numbers people actually type. Replaced across sign-up, onboarding and every form that takes a number, with its own test file. This matters directly for outreach: a number that will not save is a contractor we cannot reach on WhatsApp.
- **The Contractor Platform Terms of Service were put into the platform** as a signable document, together with the acceptance flow around it.
- **A contractor now hears back when onboarding is complete.** Previously they finished the form and received nothing.
- **The partner application became one question per screen**, with navigation that adapts to the answers. This is what makes it possible to see where people stop, which was impossible with a single long form.
- **An 'almost there' step** was added at the end of contractor onboarding.

- **Contractors can create a project without first onboarding a client.** Before this a contractor with their own build had no way in at all.

Wednesday 28 October

57 commits — the largest day of the week

The project-creation wizard: reading documents instead of asking questions.

- **A contractor uploads a floor plan and a bill of quantities, and Groundwork reads them.** It takes the total from the bill, the number of floors, the footprint area and the currency, so nobody retypes figures they already have on paper. This was the single largest piece of work in the week and involved document reading, text extraction from scans, and currency detection.
- **Multiple floor plans are supported**, with proper file validation, so a building drawn across several sheets uploads as it exists.
- **'Your project at a glance'** — a summary screen that comes back pre-filled from the uploaded documents, so the contractor confirms rather than enters.
- **Target start and end dates** were added to the wizard.
- **Country selection was reworked** so the countries we serve come first and search works.
- **A large amount of dead weight was removed:** the old payment modal, the Jalla Verify checkout, the subscription tab, unused plan logic and several payment routes that led nowhere. Roughly 2,700 lines were deleted across the week, most of them here. Fewer places for a user to get lost, and less to maintain.
- **Sign-up gives real feedback** when registration succeeds or fails, instead of leaving people guessing.
- **The three-project cap was corrected, then removed.** It had been applied to contractors, though it was only ever meant as a client plan limit.

Thursday 29 October

14 commits, plus the full design set

The contractor surface: designed, then built.

- **Twenty-two screen designs were produced** — eleven screens, each at desktop and phone size, with written design notes. They cover the Dashboard, Projects, the five tabs inside a project (Work, Money, Documents, Messages, People), Payouts, Verification, Partner and Profile. These were reviewed and approved before any of them were built, and they are in the repository as a shared reference.
- **The contractor surface was then rebuilt to match.** The People tab is new: it shows who is on a project and is where a contractor invites their client.
- **Money is shown in the project's own currency with the dollar beside it**, using a live exchange rate fetched once per session rather than a stale stored figure.
- **Contractors can own their own projects.** Previously a contractor who built their own project was treated as a client afterwards and dropped into the wrong part of the app.
- **A project can be started at the stage it has actually reached**, so a build already half finished can be brought onto Groundwork as it is.

Friday 30 October

11 commits, plus a three-hour live working session

Mobile, the live review with Philip, and a long list of corrections.

- **A bottom tab bar for mobile** — Dashboard, Projects, Payouts, Profile — across all ten contractor screens. Every approved design showed one; the app had a hamburger menu. This was the largest single gap between the designs and the build.
- **The navigation bug Philip reported was traced and fixed.** Pressing 'New project', or the logo inside it, sent a contractor into the client view. The cause was that the project wizard had its logo hard-coded to the client dashboard while its Cancel button was role-aware — two controls leaving the same screen with different

ideas of where 'out' was.

- **A screen inside the wizard was rendering with no frame at all** — no logo, no background, no way out except pressing Back twice. Found while investigating the above.
- **Help was rebuilt for contractors.** The Help button led to a page that lives inside the client layout, so a contractor pressing it landed in the client's sidebar. There is now a separate contractor help page, with contractor questions and full French translation.
- **The client invitation email was written.** It had never existed: the system recorded the invitation, showed 'Invitation sent to...', and sent nothing. Every person invited since that feature shipped was told mail had gone out when none had.
- **Money figures were corrected.** 'Contract value' and 'Still to come' now come from the project schedule, and a stage finished before the project joined Groundwork no longer distorts the totals.
- **Philip's recorded review was applied in full** — roughly forty wording and layout changes across the dashboard, Work, Money, Documents, People and Profile, in English and French.

Saturday 31 October

Continuing from Friday's session

Measurement: making the numbers the team reports trustworthy.

- **A shared definition of a qualified and a verified project** was written into the database, so every report counts the same thing. Qualified means a bill of quantities *and* a start date within 60 days. Verified means the client actually accepted their invitation *and* there is at least one site update. Everything else is general. No shared definition existed before, which is why the numbers in Thursday's review disagreed with one another.
- **Sign-up, contractor onboarding and partner application became three separate tracked sequences**, each with a real beginning and end. They were one chain, which concealed a double count: finishing onboarding with 'I have a project' was also read as the start of a partner application, so a single click was counted as the end of one thing and the start of another.
- **The negative numbers were removed from the contractor records page.** The cards showed gaps between stages as -50, -14, -10. They now show eight positive counts, and each one is clickable and filters the list beneath it. A gap between two numbers names nothing; a set of people can be opened and rung.
- **Clickable summary tiles were extended to the Projects and Site Updates pages**, built as one shared component so every admin page behaves the same way and a fix reaches all of them at once.
- **A real bug in the payment figures was found and fixed.** Philip asked where the recorded payments came from, since nobody had been paid. The page was counting every row in the payment ledger, including money coming *in* from clients and payments that had failed or were only authorised. It now counts only money that actually reached a contractor.
- **The project start date is now mandatory**, because it is half of what makes a project qualified, and a field nobody fills in is a number nobody can report.
- **A note alone can no longer be submitted as site work.** A photo or file is required, as Philip asked — otherwise an item could be ticked off with nothing to look at.

Work that is not code

Database migrations written this week

Twelve in total. Each one is a change to how information is stored or who may see it, written and tested separately from the app. The last five are not yet applied.

#	What it does	Applied
120	Lets an owner set a planned completion date when creating a project.	Yes
160	Puts the Contractor Platform Terms of Service into the platform.	Yes

#	What it does	Applied
161	Tells a contractor when their onboarding is complete.	Yes
162	Lets a project be started at the stage it has actually reached.	Yes
163	Lets a contractor take their place on a project they built themselves.	Yes
164	Corrects the three-project cap: a client limit, not a contractor one.	Yes
165	Returns the client-intent answer with the onboarding status.	Yes
166	Lets an invited client reply in the project chat.	No
167	Removes the project-creation cap entirely.	No
168	Records the devices a person is signed in on.	No
169	Defines qualified, verified and general projects, once, for everyone.	No
170	Three separate funnel sequences, each with a real start and end.	No

Screen designs

- **Twenty-two images**: eleven contractor screens, each drawn at desktop and phone size, plus three pages of written design notes and a PDF of the set.
- They live in the repository so the team shares one reference, and they were approved before the build started. Friday's session was largely a comparison of the built screens against these.

Tests

- **Fifteen new test files** this week, covering phone validation, the floor-plan and bill-of-quantities reading, currency pairing, the contractor money rules, the funnel boundaries and the qualified/verified definitions.
- **3,466 tests passing** in total, with 9 failures that pre-date this week and are unchanged by it. No type errors.
- The five unapplied migrations were each run against a real PostgreSQL database before being called finished, including checks that the right people can read them and the wrong people cannot.

Problems found while building, that nobody had reported

These were not on any list. They were found by checking work rather than assuming it, and each one was producing something false on screen.

- **The client invitation email had never been sent**, while the screen said it had.
- **Payments that never happened were being displayed as money received**, because the page counted client money coming in and payments that had failed.
- **A screen inside the project wizard rendered with no frame**, no logo and no way out.
- **The partner page crashed** for some applicants, from a fault that pre-dated this week's work.
- **Raw database errors were being shown to applicants** when they re-submitted.
- **Contractors were being counted twice** in the funnel, once as finishing onboarding and once as starting a partner application, from the same single click.

Where things stand

Finished and checked in a browser

Each of these was driven in a real browser at desktop and phone width before being called done.

- Contractor dashboard, Projects list and all five project tabs.
- Mobile bottom tab bar on all ten contractor screens.

- Navigation: the logo, Cancel and Help all keep a contractor in their own view.
- Contractor help page, English and French.
- Photo and file upload, including the camera on a phone.
- All of Philip's wording changes from the Friday recording.

Built and tested, but not yet seen in a browser

- **The mandatory project start date.** The logic is covered by tests; the screen has not been clicked through.
- **Every admin page changed this week** — contractor records, Projects and Site Updates. The test account available is a contractor, not an administrator, so none of those pages could be opened. They need an admin login before the numbers on them are relied on.

Blocked — these need an action, not more development

> **Five migrations are written and tested but not applied**
>
> **166** lets an invited client reply in the project chat. Until it runs, a client can watch a project but cannot speak in it.
>
> **167** and **168** were already outstanding from last week.
>
> **169** is the qualified / verified project definition. Until it runs, the Projects page cannot show those tiles.
>
> **170** is the three-sequence funnel tracking. Until it runs, nothing is being measured.
>
> Each has been validated against a real PostgreSQL database and needs running in Supabase.

- **Nothing is deployed.** All of this week's work sits on the development machine.
- **RESEND_API_KEY must be set in Vercel**, or the new client invitation email will still not send.

Not started

- **The Documents section rebuild.** Philip identified this as a real rework rather than a wording change: filtering, searching and organising documents, and files that currently cannot be opened.
- **Summary tiles on the remaining admin pages** — Overview, Action Center, Reviews, Inspections, Tasks, Finance, Clients, Contractors, Partner pipeline, Verifiers. The shared component exists; each page needs its own set of slices.
- **The contractor walkthrough** — four guided flows: completing a profile, applying to be a partner, inviting a client, managing a project. Requested in both the team memo and the Chia walkthrough session.
- **The client walkthrough** — the same request, for the client side.
- **Contractor onboarding clean-up** — the sign-up, login and email confirmation problems Kiitu Ghislain hit on Tuesday are still open.
- **Verification revenue mapping.** Worth noting that verification is currently hidden across the contractor surface, so this would map a journey to a feature that is switched off.
- **Removing test projects** from the live platform, so the figures and the screens are readable.

Decisions waiting on Philip or Favour

None of these blocks work today, but each is a question only they can answer.

- Should the Money progress bar track approved stage value, or money actually paid? They are genuinely different numbers, which is why they disagree on screen.
- Should the contractor agreement signature have to match the name on the account? At present any two characters are accepted as a signature.
- Philip asked to remove the sentence telling French applicants that Vanessa joins their call. Her name was kept in the 'who you will speak to' list — should that go as well?
- Is Vanessa actually a co-host on the French booking calendar? The platform sends French applicants to the correct separate calendar, but who is on that calendar is set in Google and cannot be checked from the

platform.

Figures are taken from the project's version history, not from memory. Period covered: Monday 26 October to Saturday 31 October 2026.